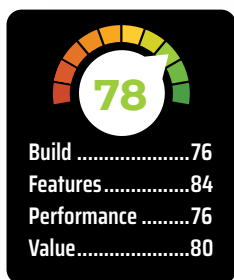


OPPO Enco Air3 Pro

The best-sounding TWS under ₹5,000

The sub-₹5K truly wireless earphones market in India witnesses some intense, cutthroat competition. Several brands offer premium features such as Active Noise Cancellation, multipoint connection, and accompanying app support in this price segment. Prime examples would be the OnePlus Buds Z2 and Realme Buds Air 3. OPPO is no stranger to offering compelling TWS options on a budget. For instance, the OPPO Enco X2, which is one of my favourite TWS earphones, plays in the big leagues by providing a mix of fantastic performance and a plethora of features. Now, the company has launched a new player in the sub-₹5,000 segment to shake things up! Enter the OPPO Enco Air3 Pro. An affordable yet accomplished pair of TWS earphones with LDAC codec support, up to 49 dB of Adaptive ANC, low latency mode, multiconnect, and much more. Looks mighty impressive on paper, but does it live up to the expectations? Let's find out!



BUILD, DESIGN, AND FIT

The OPPO Enco Air3 Pro have an understated look with some subtle flair. OPPO has incorporated a gradient design for the charging case where the top goes from being translucent to fully opaque. It's a neat look that distinguishes it from the sea of white TWS in the market. The pastel Green colour variant looks even more eye-catching, in my opinion.

The case is compact and can easily slip into small purses or pockets. There's OPPO branding adorning the front alongside an LED indicator button that relays pairing and battery information. The bottom houses the USB Type-C charging port, and that's about it. The case's hinge seems sturdy enough upon inspection but some metal reinforcements would be even more reassuring.

Upon opening the case, you see the buds neatly tucked in. The R and L indicators on the earbuds are large enough to be noticed from a mile away; convenient but a bit garish, maybe? Nevertheless, the buds are diminutive in size. According to OPPO, the stems are 6 per

cent shorter than its predecessor – the OPPO Enco Air2 Pro. The charging case has also seen a reduction in size.

The buds are pretty comfortable to wear over long periods; they're extremely lightweight and the Medium eartips gave me a super snug fit. I would easily recommend these to anyone looking for workout earbuds seeing that they've got a good fit and IP55 water and dust resistance to boot.

FEATURES

OPPO has packed the Enco Air3 Pro with features! You would be hard-pressed to find a more feature-rich pair of TWS earphones under ₹5,000. Let's run through these features. First and foremost, there's support for up to 49 dB Adaptive Active Noise Cancellation. So, not only do you get decent ANC per-

formance, but it also uses AI to cleverly optimise the noise cancellation levels depending on your surroundings. In my experience, the ANC performance was decent. It's not good enough to suppress traffic sounds, but will quiet down things such as an AC's hum.

There's also a Transparency Mode that amplifies surrounding sounds to keep you aware but it sounds a bit tinny and unnatural. You also get other niceties such as multiconnect which allows you to connect to two devices simultaneously, such as a laptop and phone, and switch between them without a hitch. It worked flawlessly for me!

The buds are supported on the Hey-Melody app which opens up a bunch of customisation opportunities for users. There are the basics such as checking your buds' battery percentage, switching between noise cancellation modes, and personalising ANC according to your hearing. You can even switch to 'Smart' noise cancellation which adapts to the environment, as we mentioned before.

There are some preset EQs you can choose from – Original Sound, Bass Boost, and Natural Inspiration. Natural Inspiration is quite bright and Bass Boost is well... the opposite. I tested the earphones on Original Sound, which proved to be quite balanced. Sadly, there's no customisable EQ; a missed opportunity in my books. The app also allows you to toggle features such as Golden Sound and OPPO Alive Audio. Golden Sound creates a custom sound signature based on your ear canal's shape and hearing abilities while Alive Audio is OPPO's rendition of spatial audio.

I turned on Alive Audio and there was an immediate difference when listening to music on YouTube Music. The soundstage was much wider and audio cues originated from all around me rather than just the right and left channels. Cool stuff at ₹5K! Golden Sound, honestly, didn't create a tangible difference in the sound but it could be extremely useful for those who are facing hearing disabilities.

The app also lets users toggle on Game Mode which lowers the earphone latency